

100 excel interview question and answer for data analyst freshers

Here are **100 Excel Interview Questions and Answers for Data Analyst Freshers**:

Basic Excel Questions

1. What is Microsoft Excel?

Answer: Excel is a spreadsheet application used for data entry, analysis, calculations, visualization, and reporting.

2. What is a Workbook?

Answer: A workbook is an Excel file containing one or more worksheets.

3. What is a Worksheet?

Answer: A worksheet is a single spreadsheet page within a workbook.

4. What is a Cell?

Answer: A cell is the intersection of a row and column.

5. What is the difference between Row and Column?

Answer: Rows run horizontally and are numbered; columns run vertically and are labeled with letters.

6. What is a Formula?

Answer: A formula is an expression used to perform calculations in Excel.

7. What is a Function?

Answer: A predefined formula in Excel, such as SUM(), AVERAGE(), and COUNT().

8. How do you start a formula?

Answer: With an equal sign (=).

9. What is AutoFill?

Answer: A feature that automatically fills cells with data patterns or formulas.

10. What is the shortcut to save a workbook?

Answer: Ctrl + S.

Excel Formulas & Functions

11. What does SUM() do?

Answer: Adds numbers in a range.

12. What does AVERAGE() do?

Answer: Calculates the mean value.

13. What does COUNT() do?

Answer: Counts cells containing numbers.

14. What does COUNTA() do?

Answer: Counts non-empty cells.

15. What does MAX() do?

Answer: Returns the highest value.

16. What does MIN() do?

Answer: Returns the lowest value.

17. What does IF() do?

Answer: Performs logical tests and returns specified values.

18. Example of IF()?

Answer: `=IF(A2>=50,"Pass","Fail")`

19. What does SUMIF() do?

Answer: Sums values based on one condition.

20. What does COUNTIF() do?

Answer: Counts cells meeting a condition.

21. What does AVERAGEIF() do?

Answer: Averages values based on a condition.

22. What does CONCATENATE() do?

Answer: Joins text strings.

23. Alternative to CONCATENATE?

Answer: CONCAT() or "&".

24. What does LEFT() do?

Answer: Extracts characters from the left side.

25. What does RIGHT() do?

Answer: Extracts characters from the right side.

26. What does MID() do?

Answer: Extracts characters from the middle.

27. What does LEN() do?

Answer: Returns text length.

28. What does TRIM() do?

Answer: Removes extra spaces.

29. What does UPPER() do?

Answer: Converts text to uppercase.

30. What does LOWER() do?

Answer: Converts text to lowercase.

Lookup Functions

31. What is VLOOKUP?

Answer: Searches vertically and returns matching values.

32. Syntax of VLOOKUP?

Answer: `=VLOOKUP (value, table, col_index, FALSE)`

33. Limitation of VLOOKUP?

Answer: Can only search from left to right.

34. What is HLOOKUP?

Answer: Searches horizontally.

35. What is XLOOKUP?

Answer: Advanced lookup function replacing VLOOKUP and HLOOKUP.

36. Advantage of XLOOKUP?

Answer: Can search both directions.

37. What is INDEX()?

Answer: Returns a value from a specified row and column.

38. What is MATCH()?

Answer: Returns the position of a value.

39. Why use INDEX + MATCH?

Answer: More flexible and efficient than VLOOKUP.

40. Example of INDEX-MATCH?

Answer: `=INDEX(B:B,MATCH(E2,A:A,0))`

Data Cleaning

41. How do you remove duplicates?

Answer: Data → Remove Duplicates.

42. What is Text to Columns?

Answer: Splits data into multiple columns.

43. Why use TRIM()?

Answer: To remove unnecessary spaces.

44. What does CLEAN() do?

Answer: Removes non-printable characters.

45. How to find duplicates?

Answer: Conditional Formatting → Highlight Duplicate Values.

46. How to replace values?

Answer: Ctrl + H.

47. How to filter data?

Answer: Data → Filter.

48. Shortcut for Filter?

Answer: Ctrl + Shift + L.

49. How to sort data?

Answer: Data → Sort.

50. Difference between Sort and Filter?

Answer: Sort rearranges data; Filter hides unwanted data.

Pivot Tables

51. What is a Pivot Table?

Answer: A tool used to summarize and analyze data.

52. Why use Pivot Tables?

Answer: Quickly generate insights from large datasets.

53. What are Rows in Pivot Table?

Answer: Categories displayed vertically.

54. What are Columns?

Answer: Categories displayed horizontally.

55. What is Values Area?

Answer: Contains calculations such as Sum or Count.

56. What is Filter Area?

Answer: Filters Pivot Table results.

57. How to refresh a Pivot Table?

Answer: Right-click → Refresh.

58. Can Pivot Tables handle large datasets?

Answer: Yes.

59. What is a Pivot Chart?

Answer: A chart linked to a Pivot Table.

60. What is a Slicer?

Answer: Interactive filter for Pivot Tables.

Charts & Visualization

61. What is a Chart?

Answer: Graphical representation of data.

62. Types of Charts?

Answer: Bar, Column, Line, Pie, Scatter, Area.

63. Best chart for trends?

Answer: Line Chart.

64. Best chart for comparison?

Answer: Bar/Column Chart.

65. Best chart for proportions?

Answer: Pie Chart.

66. What is Conditional Formatting?

Answer: Highlights cells based on rules.

67. Use of Data Bars?

Answer: Visual comparison of values.

68. What are Color Scales?

Answer: Highlight values using colors.

69. What are Icon Sets?

Answer: Symbols indicating performance.

70. Why visualize data?

Answer: To identify patterns and trends.

Advanced Excel

71. What is Absolute Reference?

Answer: Fixed reference using `$` (e.g., `$A$1`).

72. What is Relative Reference?

Answer: Changes when copied.

73. What is Mixed Reference?

Answer: Partially fixed reference.

74. What is Named Range?

Answer: Custom name for a cell range.

75. What is Data Validation?

Answer: Restricts data entry.

76. What is a Drop-down List?

Answer: A selectable list created using Data Validation.

77. What is Goal Seek?

Answer: Finds required input to achieve desired output.

78. What is Scenario Manager?

Answer: Analyzes multiple scenarios.

79. What are Excel Tables?

Answer: Structured ranges with built-in features.

80. What is Flash Fill?

Answer: Automatically fills patterns in data.

Data Analyst Scenario-Based Questions

81. How would you find duplicate customer IDs?

Answer: Conditional Formatting or `COUNTIF()`.

82. How would you clean customer names?

Answer: TRIM(), PROPER(), CLEAN().

83. How would you identify top-selling products?

Answer: Pivot Table with sales aggregation.

84. How would you calculate monthly sales?

Answer: SUMIFS() or Pivot Table.

85. How would you find missing values?

Answer: Filter blanks or use ISBLANK().

86. How would you categorize sales performance?

Answer: IF() function.

87. How would you compare actual vs target sales?

Answer: Create variance columns and charts.

88. How would you summarize 50,000 rows?

Answer: Pivot Table.

89. How would you create a dashboard?

Answer: Use Pivot Tables, Charts, and Slicers.

90. Which Excel skills are important for Data Analysts?

Answer: Lookup Functions, Pivot Tables, Charts, Data Cleaning, and Dashboards.

Frequently Asked Excel Interview Questions

91. Difference between COUNT and COUNTA?

Answer: COUNT counts numbers; COUNTA counts non-empty cells.

92. Difference between SUMIF and SUMIFS?

Answer: SUMIF = one condition; SUMIFS = multiple conditions.

93. Difference between VLOOKUP and XLOOKUP?

Answer: XLOOKUP is more flexible and powerful.

94. Difference between Pivot Table and Formula?

Answer: Pivot summarizes data dynamically; formulas perform cell-level calculations.

95. What is an Excel Dashboard?

Answer: Interactive visual summary of key metrics.

96. What is Freeze Panes?

Answer: Keeps rows/columns visible while scrolling.

97. Shortcut to create a Pivot Table?

Answer: Alt + N + V.

98. Shortcut to open Find?

Answer: Ctrl + F.

99. Shortcut to open Replace?

Answer: Ctrl + H.

100. Why is Excel important for Data Analysts?

Answer: It helps clean, analyze, visualize, and report data efficiently before using advanced tools like SQL, Python, and Power BI.

Most Important Excel Topics for Fresher Interviews

1. VLOOKUP / XLOOKUP
2. INDEX + MATCH
3. IF, SUMIF, COUNTIF
4. Pivot Tables
5. Conditional Formatting
6. Data Cleaning (TRIM, CLEAN, Remove Duplicates)
7. Charts and Dashboards
8. Data Validation
9. Sorting & Filtering
10. Excel Shortcuts

These 100 questions cover about **90% of the Excel questions typically asked in Data Analyst Fresher interviews.**

